strategies of superpowers to maintain their spheres of influence resulted in the formation of military pacts like the Australia, New Zealand, United States Security Treaty (ANZUS, 1 Sept, 1951), Central Treaty Organization, also known as Baghdad Pact, 1955, (CENTO, 1958–1979, dissolved in 1979) and Southeast Asia Treaty Organization, or the Manila Pact (SEATO, 8 Sept, 1954, dissolved in 1977), to which India's neighbour Pakistan was being drawn into, prompted India to embark upon the policy of non-alignment. Nehru made it clear that India would belong to one camp—the camp of peace, goodwill and cooperation. An essential aspect of the policy of non-alignment is, in the words of Nehru, "the enlargement of freedom and replacement of colonization by free and independent countries and a large degree of cooperation among nations".[2]

The Arab leaders' choice of the policy of non-alignment primarily arose from their desire to ward off a conflict in their area between the great powers, or at any rate not to provide them a pretext for intervention. The Suez Crisis was an eye-opener and the Arabs realized the possibilities of other infamous self-serving intrusions in their region. To this end, they pursued a non-aligned course and also harped on Arab solidarity and enhanced military strength to deter potential aggression from the Zionist [incubus] in the heart of the Arab world.[3]

The African states imbibed the spirit of non-alignment in an effort to retain the sovereignty of the newly independent states. They further worked towards a common purpose to keep off the foreign powers out of Africa, to solve *inter se* (their own) problems themselves, to aid African National Liberation Movements and to fight against white racism. The decision of the African states to join the non-aligned group en bloc can be considered as essentially an anti-imperialist gesture.

Cuba's decision to join the non-aligned movement was one of its pragmatic considerations. The US military base at Guantanamo was one of the reasons that prompted Cuba to join a movement that was opposed to the foreign military bases. Further, being isolated in Latin America in the 1960s, Cuba felt a compelling need to belong somewhere and non-alignment seemed to be a good choice which